

ElevateX

Official Framework Document

ElevateX Drive Performance Index

EDPI

One score that shows how well a drive turned money, people and time into real impact.

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Date 14th November, 2025

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1 Why we built EDPI

This document is for anyone who wants to see how ElevateX measures its work. It explains the Drive Performance Index (EDPI) from start to finish: what it measures, how it is calculated and why it is built the way it is.

Every ElevateX drive takes money, time and a lot of effort from our members. Until now, there was no clear way to say whether one drive went better than another. A big drive is not always a better drive, and a cheap drive is not always a good one.

EDPI fixes this by giving every drive one score. It looks at three things:

- **Money:** Did we spend wisely, and did we stay inside the fund?
- **Volunteers:** Did enough people show up, and was the work shared fairly?
- **Impact:** Did we actually achieve what we set out to do?

A drive that does exactly what it planned scores **100**. It can go above 100 by getting more volunteers than planned and by working with an outside partner. The highest possible score is **115**.

2 How a drive is scored

Every drive follows the same five steps.

Step 1. Make the plan before the drive. The organiser fills in six planning values (Table 2). These are the targets the drive will be judged against.

Step 2. Lock the plan. Once the drive starts, nobody changes these values. If targets could be changed afterwards, the score would mean nothing.

Step 3. Run the drive and keep records. The team keeps receipts for the money spent, a count of the people helped, a sign-in sheet with each volunteer's hours, and a record of the

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impact achieved.

Step 4. Enter the results after the drive. Five values are recorded (Table 1).

Step 5. Calculate and read the score. The result comes from the formulas in Section 5 and is read as explained in Section 7.

3 Inputs

Every input has a simple name, and the same names are used in every formula.

Entered after the drive

Name	Meaning	Unit	Rule
Spent	Total money spent on the drive	Rs.	0 or more
PeopleHelped	Total number of beneficiaries reached	people	whole number, 0 or more
Volunteers	Number of volunteers who actually took part	people	whole number, 0 or more
HoursEach	Hours given by each volunteer (one entry per volunteer)	hours	between MinHours and MaxHours
ImpactDone	Impact actually achieved, in the drive's own unit (meals, kg, trees, books)	impact units	0 or more

Table 1: Results entered after the drive.

Set before the drive (locked once it starts)

Name	Meaning	Unit	Rule
PlannedVolunteers	Number of volunteers we expect	people	more than 0
PlannedHours	Average hours we expect from each volunteer	hours	more than 0
ImpactTarget	Impact we aim for, in the same unit as ImpactDone	impact units	more than 0
Budget	Money set aside for this drive	Rs.	more than 0
NormalCost	Usual cost per beneficiary (currently Rs. 53.42)	Rs. per person	more than 0
HasPartner	1 if the drive has at least one outside partner, otherwise 0	yes or no	0 or 1

Table 2: Planning values set before the drive.

4 Fixed settings

These numbers are set by ElevateX and are the same for every drive. If we ever want to change one, we change it here and nowhere else.

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Name	Meaning	Value
NormalCost	Usual cost per beneficiary	Rs. 53.42
OverspendStart	Using more than this share of the fund starts losing points	1.00 (100%)
OverspendZero	Share of the fund at which the budget score hits 0	1.50 (150%)
TurnoutMax	Highest turnout score allowed	150
W_{Money}	Weight of the money score	0.25
$W_{Volunteer}$	Weight of the volunteer score	0.25
W_{Impact}	Weight of the impact score	0.50
PartnerBonusMax	Bonus points for an outside partner	10
MinHours, MaxHours	Believable hours for one volunteer, used to catch typing mistakes	0.5 and 24

Table 3: Fixed settings.

The three weights always add up to 1.

5 The calculation

The calculation has four steps. After each one there is a short box that explains what the step does, why we need it and the thinking behind it.

Step 1: Basic figures

$$\mathsf{TotalHours} = \sum_{i=1}^{\mathsf{Volunteers}} \mathsf{HoursEach}_i$$

$$\mathsf{AvgHours} = \frac{\mathsf{TotalHours}}{\mathsf{Volunteers}}$$

$$\mathsf{CostPerPerson} = \frac{\mathsf{Spent}}{\mathsf{PeopleHelped}}$$

$$\mathsf{BudgetUsed} = \frac{\mathsf{Spent}}{\mathsf{Budget}}$$

What it does. Turns the raw entries into four simple figures: total volunteer hours, average hours per volunteer, money spent per beneficiary, and the share of the fund we used (1.00 means we used all of it).

Why we need it. We can't fairly compare a small drive with a big one using raw totals. Averages and ratios take the size out of the picture.

The thinking behind it. Each figure is just an addition or a division. There is no judgement in this step.

Step 2: Four scores

Each score is out of 100, except turnout, which can go higher. A higher score is always better.

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Cost score

$$\text{CostScore} = \begin{cases} 100 & \text{if CostPerPerson} \le \text{NormalCost} \\ \dfrac{100 \times \text{NormalCost}}{\text{CostPerPerson}} & \text{if CostPerPerson} > \text{NormalCost} \end{cases}$$

With NormalCost = 53.42, the second case works out to 5342/CostPerPerson.

What it does. Compares what the drive spent on each beneficiary with what ElevateX usually spends.

Why we need it. Money spent only means something when we know how many people it helped. Looking at total spending alone would make small drives look better than they are.

The thinking behind it. The score is the usual cost divided by the actual cost. If a drive spends twice the usual amount per person, it gets 50. If it spends less than usual, it gets full marks but nothing extra, so one very cheap drive can't hide problems somewhere else.

Budget score

$$\text{BudgetScore} = \begin{cases} 100 & \text{if BudgetUsed} \le \text{OverspendStart} \\ 100 - 100 \times \dfrac{\text{BudgetUsed} - \text{OverspendStart}}{\text{OverspendZero} - \text{OverspendStart}} & \text{if between the two limits} \\ 0 & \text{if BudgetUsed} \ge \text{OverspendZero} \end{cases}$$

"Between the two limits" means BudgetUsed is above OverspendStart but below OverspendZero. With the fixed settings, the middle case loses 2 points for every extra 1% of the fund spent.

What it does. Checks that the drive stayed inside its fund.

Why we need it. Going over budget takes money away from other drives, so it needs its own penalty.

The thinking behind it. There is no penalty up to 100% of the fund. After that, the score drops in a straight line and reaches 0 at 150%. We deliberately do not score underspending here. A drive that does less already loses points through cost per person and through impact. If we rewarded spending more, it would cancel out the cost score, because the extra spending and the higher cost per person would balance each other exactly.

Turnout score

$$\text{TurnoutScore} = \begin{cases} 100 \times \dfrac{\text{Volunteers}}{\text{PlannedVolunteers}} & \text{if this is at most TurnoutMax} \\ \text{TurnoutMax} & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

What it does. Compares the number of volunteers who came with the number we expected.

Why we need it. A big turnout shows that the drive reached people and got them involved, so it should be rewarded, even when it goes beyond the plan.

The thinking behind it. The score is the actual number divided by the planned number. Half the planned turnout gives 50, the planned turnout gives 100, and anything above that earns extra credit up to TurnoutMax. The limit stops one huge crowd from taking over the whole index.

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Time score

$$\text{TimeScore} = \begin{cases} 100 & \text{if AvgHours} \leq \text{PlannedHours} \\ \dfrac{100 \times \text{PlannedHours}}{\text{AvgHours}} & \text{if AvgHours} > \text{PlannedHours} \end{cases}$$

What it does. Compares the average hours each volunteer gave with the hours we planned.

Why we need it. If each volunteer has to give a lot of time, the drive is asking too much of its people. Fewer hours per volunteer means the work was shared well.

The thinking behind it. The score is the planned hours divided by the actual hours, so doubling the planned hours gives 50. Hours at or below the plan score 100.

Step 3: Three pillars and a bonus

Money score

$$\text{MoneyScore} = \sqrt{\text{CostScore} \times \text{BudgetScore}}$$

What it does. Combines the cost score and the budget score into one score for money.

Why we need it. A drive can be cheap per person and still overspend, or stay on budget and still waste money. Doing well financially means getting both right.

The thinking behind it. The square root of the two scores multiplied together is called the geometric mean. It equals the normal average when the two scores are the same, and it falls below the normal average when they are far apart. If either score is 0, the money score is 0.

Volunteer score

$$\text{VolunteerScore} = \begin{cases} \dfrac{2 \times \text{TurnoutScore} \times \text{TimeScore}}{\text{TurnoutScore} + \text{TimeScore}} & \text{if TurnoutScore} + \text{TimeScore} > 0 \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

What it does. Combines turnout and time per volunteer into one score for volunteers.

Why we need it. A big crowd is only good news if the work was shared fairly, and light hours mean little if hardly anyone came.

The thinking behind it. This is called the harmonic mean. It stays closer to the weaker of the two scores, so a strong result on one can't cover up a weak result on the other. For example, a turnout score of 150 with a time score of 50 gives 75, not the normal average of 100.

Impact score

$$\text{ImpactScore} = \begin{cases} 100 \times \dfrac{\text{ImpactDone}}{\text{ImpactTarget}} & \text{if ImpactDone} < \text{ImpactTarget} \\ 100 & \text{if ImpactDone} \geq \text{ImpactTarget} \end{cases}$$

What it does. Measures what share of the impact target we actually reached.

Why we need it. Money and volunteers are what we put in. Impact is the reason the drive exists.

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The thinking behind it. The score is the actual impact divided by the target. Hitting the target gives 100. The target has to be set before the drive, in the unit the drive really produces, like meals served or kilograms collected.

Partnership bonus

$$\mathsf{PartnerBonus} = \begin{cases} \mathsf{PartnerBonusMax} & \text{if } \mathsf{HasPartner} = 1 \\ 0 & \text{if } \mathsf{HasPartner} = 0 \end{cases}$$

What it does. Adds 10 points when the drive worked with at least one outside partner.

Why we need it. Partnerships help ElevateX reach more people, but not every drive needs one.

The thinking behind it. It is a bonus on top of the main score, not one of the three pillars, so a drive without a partner doesn't lose anything.

Step 4: The final index

$$\boxed{\begin{aligned}\mathsf{EDPI} = {} & \mathsf{W}_{\mathsf{Money}}\,\mathsf{MoneyScore} + \mathsf{W}_{\mathsf{Volunteer}}\,\mathsf{VolunteerScore} \\ & + \mathsf{W}_{\mathsf{Impact}}\,\mathsf{ImpactScore} + \mathsf{PartnerBonus}\end{aligned}}$$

With the fixed settings, this is

$$\mathsf{EDPI} = 0.25 \times \mathsf{MoneyScore} + 0.25 \times \mathsf{VolunteerScore} + 0.50 \times \mathsf{ImpactScore} + \mathsf{PartnerBonus}.$$

What it does. Adds the three weighted pillars and the bonus to get one final number.

Why we need it. Members and organisers need a single score so they can compare drives and see whether we are improving.

The thinking behind it. A weighted sum is easy to check by hand. Impact gets half of the weight because it is the whole point of a drive. Money and volunteers share the other half equally.

Part		Highest possible
MoneyScore		100
VolunteerScore	120	(turnout 150, time 100)
ImpactScore		100
Weighted total		105
PartnerBonus		10
EDPI		**115**

Table 4: The highest possible value of each part.

6 Worked example

Here is one drive, scored from start to finish. We planned for 40 volunteers working 4 hours each, with a fund of Rs. 60,000 and a target of 1,000 meals. In the end we spent Rs. 50,000, reached 800

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people, had 50 volunteers who gave 150 hours in total, served 900 meals and worked with one outside partner.

Variable	Calculation	Result
AvgHours	150/50	3 hours
CostPerPerson	50,000/800	Rs. 62.50
BudgetUsed	50,000/60,000	0.833
CostScore	$62.50 > 53.42$, so 5342/62.50	85.47
BudgetScore	$0.833 \leq 1.00$	100
TurnoutScore	$100 \times 50/40 = 125$, which is within 150	125
TimeScore	$3 \leq 4$	100
MoneyScore	$\sqrt{85.47 \times 100}$	92.45
VolunteerScore	$2 \times 125 \times 100/(125 + 100)$	111.11
ImpactScore	$100 \times 900/1000$	90
PartnerBonus	HasPartner $= 1$	10
EDPI	$0.25 \times 92.45 + 0.25 \times 111.11 + 0.50 \times 90 + 10$	**105.89**

Table 5: Scoring one drive step by step.

This drive scored 105.89. More volunteers came than we planned and we had a partner, which pushed the score up. But we spent more per person than usual and reached only 90% of our impact target, so the score stayed below the maximum.

7 Reading the score

EDPI does not come with a fixed pass mark, and that is on purpose. Here is the thinking behind how to read it.

- **100 is the reference point.** Every score compares the result with the plan, so 100 means the drive did what it said it would do. We chose this because a score is easier to understand when it is measured against the drive's own goals and not against some number that was picked at random.
- **Above 100 means the drive beat its plan.** This can happen through extra turnout or a partnership. Because turnout is limited and impact is not allowed to go past 100, one lucky area can't push a drive far above the rest.
- **Below 100 means something fell short, and the pillar scores say what.** Look at MoneyScore, VolunteerScore and ImpactScore one by one. The one furthest below 100 is the area to talk about in the debrief.
- **Compare a drive with our past drives of the same type.** Because every score is measured against that drive's own plan, a rising score over time shows that we are planning better and delivering better.

We chose not to set labels like "good" or "poor" for ranges of scores. Any cut-off would be a guess until ElevateX has scored enough drives to know what a typical result looks like.

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8 Data rules

These rules cover what happens when a number is zero or looks wrong.

Situation	Rule
PeopleHelped $= 0$	CostScore $= 0$, and flag the record
Spent $= 0$ and PeopleHelped > 0	CostScore $= 100$
Volunteers $= 0$	TurnoutScore, TimeScore and VolunteerScore are all 0
Number of HoursEach entries is not equal to Volunteers	Reject the submission
Any HoursEach above MaxHours or below MinHours	Flag for review
Spent above $1.5\times$ Budget	Flag for review (BudgetScore is already 0)
Any planning value is 0 or less	Reject, because the plan is not valid
A planning value changed after the drive started	Reject, because planning values are locked

Table 6: Edge cases and data checks.

The minimum-hours check is important. A low average raises the time score, so without the check a drive could add volunteers who log almost no time and look good on both turnout and time.

9 Design choices and limitations

Why EDPI looks the way it does

- **Everything is compared with a plan.** This makes drives of different sizes comparable.
- **Cost is measured per beneficiary.** It shows how well money turns into help.
- **Geometric mean for money, harmonic mean for volunteers.** Both stop a strong result in one area from hiding a weak result in another.
- **Impact gets half the weight.** It is the purpose of the drive.
- **Scores have limits.** Without limits, one extreme number could decide the whole index.
- **Partnerships are a bonus.** They help, but a drive doesn't need one.

Limitations

- The weights and limits are choices made by ElevateX. They are not the result of a statistical study, and another organisation might choose different ones.
- The impact score uses one impact measure per drive. It can't capture how good the help was or how long it lasts.
- Planned values are set by the organiser, so the index is only fair if targets are realistic and locked before the drive.
- Volunteer hours are written down by people, so they should be checked against the sign-in sheet.
- EDPI is new. We will review the settings as more drives are scored.

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10 Credits and ownership

The ElevateX Drive Performance Index was designed and developed in full by **Vivaan Agarwal** for ElevateX. This includes the idea, the mathematical framework, the scoring rules and this document.

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